Problem and research question

AI speeds up prototyping, while validation remains slow and fragmented.

IDEA DILIGENCE

An evidence-based validation agent for early product ideas

THE DECISION GAP

1 **Markets change faster than static reports**

Founders need current competitors and substitutes.

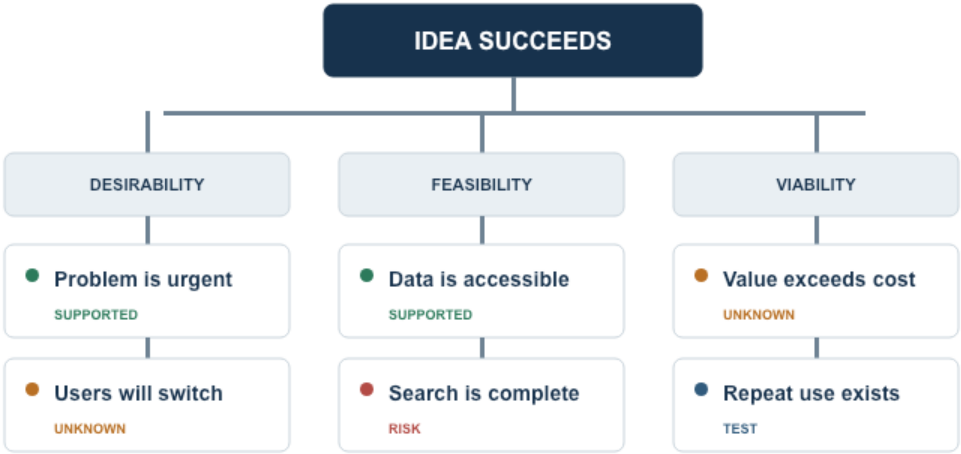
2 **Most research inventories facts**

It rarely exposes the beliefs that drive success.

3 **Internet evidence cannot prove demand**

Unknowns still require customer experiments.

ASSUMPTIONS REQUIRED FOR SUCCESS



RESEARCH QUESTION

Can an assumption-first agent find better alternatives, overlooked beliefs and more useful next experiments?

Target users: early-stage founders and product managers

Competitive landscape

Market research and assumption testing remain separate workflows.

Primary focus based on public product descriptions

PRODUCT		External discovery	Cited evidence	Assumption map	Counter-evidence	Next experiment
MARKET RESEARCH	IdeaValidator	●	●	◐	—	●
	SignalDart	●	◐	—	—	—
	AlreadyBuilt	●	—	—	—	—
VALIDATION TOOLS	ValidLab	—	●	●	●	●
	Rapidly	—	◐	●	—	●
PROPOSED PILOT	Idea Diligence	◐	○	○	○	○

● Core focus ◐ Partial or secondary ○ Planned in pilot — Not central in public positioning

Idea Diligence will test a narrower hypothesis: source passages linked to prioritized assumptions and draft tests.

Sources and comparison caveats are included in speaker notes.

Product workflow

The workflow turns a raw idea into a prioritized validation plan.

1. **DESCRIBE** — Customer and problem
2. **MAP** — Success assumptions
3. **RESEARCH** — Evidence for and against
4. **RANK** — Critical unknowns
5. **TEST** — Next experiment

ILLUSTRATIVE OUTPUT

1 ASSUMPTION MAP

What must be true?

Smart shopping assistant succeeds

Problem is frequent	SUPPORTED
Users trust recommendations	OPEN
Retail data is accessible	AT RISK

2 EVIDENCE LEDGER

What supports or challenges it?

SUPPORTS

Consumers abandon comparison-heavy purchases when information overload rises.

CHALLENGES

Retailers already provide recommendation quizzes and live chat.

3 NEXT EXPERIMENT

What should the founder learn next?

CONCIERGE TEST

Will users trust a recommendation before seeing every option?

Recruit five laptop shoppers

Success: three accept and explain why

Primary format: living web workspace Export: dated PDF report

Implementation and scope

A focused MVP can make research traceable and uncertainty explicit.

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE



TERM SCOPE

IN THE MVP	DEFERRED	RISK	CONTROL
One consumer or prosumer workflow	Automated recruiting	**Incomplete search**	multi-source benchmark
Map 10–15 assumptions; research the top five	Running experiments	**Confirmation bias**	counterevidence pass
Return passages and three experiment cards	Revenue prediction	**Unsupported claims**	passage or unknown
Save workspace and export a report	Every industry	**Confidential ideas**	minimal retention

Evidence or an experiment rule determines status; the model only proposes it.

Pilot and success measures

A class pilot will test whether the tool improves founder decisions.

5–10 volunteer class ideas

Each participant provides the idea, known competitors and intended differentiation.

A GENERIC AI open-ended research	**B** STATIC SCAN competitor report	**C** IDEA DILIGENCE assumptions + evidence + test	SAME IDEA Comparable 10–15 minute research budget

SUCCESS SCORECARD

Discovery	Assumptions	Citations	Usefulness
≥1 new competitor or substitute	≥1 overlooked high-risk belief	≥90% sampled claims supported	specific next experiment chosen

MILESTONES

NOW	MIDPOINT	PILOT	FINAL
schema + recruit ideas	workflow on 3–5 ideas	compare three conditions	demo on 5–10 ideas

Small volunteer sample: exploratory usability evidence, not proof of startup viability.